Op. Dr. Murat Ayata
Kulak Burun Boğaz
Otolaryngology Head and Neck Surgery Specialist

Op. Dr. Murat Ayata Private Clinic
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INFORMED CONSENT FORM

Botulinum Toxin (Botox) Treatment

Injection treatment for expression lines, enlarged jaw muscle (masseter) or excessive sweating

Dear patient, this form has been prepared to explain, in **plain and clear language**, what you need to know about the procedure recommended to you. Its purpose is not to frighten you, but to help you make your decision **freely and on the basis of good information**.

Please read this form without rushing. Ask your doctor about anything you do not understand. Your doctor will also explain verbally any risks that are particular to your situation. Whether or not you give consent is entirely your right.

PATIENT AND PROCEDURE DETAILS

Full name: _____ Date of birth: _____

Passport / ID No: _____ File / Protocol No: _____

Telephone: _____ Date informed: _____

Planned procedure date: _____

Form first sent to patient (date / e-mail, WhatsApp, in person): _____

Doctor performing the procedure and providing information: **Op. Dr. Murat Ayata**

Place of treatment: _____

Product name / brand: _____

LOT number and expiry date: _____

Total units and dilution: _____

Treatment areas: ☐ Forehead ☐ Frown lines ☐ Crow's feet ☐ Masseter (jaw muscle) ☐ Neck ☐ Sweating (underarm / hands) ☐ Other _____

Purpose of treatment: ☐ Cosmetic ☐ Medical (teeth grinding, sweating, etc.) _____

Off-label treatment area(s): ☐ None ☐ Yes — area: _____

1 Your condition and the aim of the procedure

Botulinum toxin is a purified protein that temporarily reduces the link between the injected muscle and its nerve, so that the muscle contracts less strongly. For cosmetic purposes it is used to soften **expression lines** on the forehead, between the eyebrows and around the eyes. It is also used as a medical treatment for teeth grinding (bruxism) and enlargement of the jaw muscle (masseter), neck bands and **excessive sweating** (hyperhidrosis).

Expression lines form over the years as the same muscles contract again and again and the skin loses elasticity. The effect is **temporary**: the muscle gradually regains its function and, if treatment is not repeated, the appearance slowly returns to how it was before. The aim is a **natural, rested** look without freezing your facial expression.

2 How is the procedure performed?

The treatment is carried out in the clinic after a short consultation and examination. Your facial movements are assessed, the injection points are marked and, if necessary, photographs are taken before treatment.

1. **Preparation:** Make-up is removed and the skin is cleaned with an antiseptic solution. If you are sensitive to pain, ice or an anaesthetic cream can be applied.

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2. **Injection:** A small amount of product is injected with a very fine needle into the marked points. Each injection takes a few seconds; you may feel a slight prick or stinging.
3. **Finishing:** Gentle pressure is applied to the injection points. Small bumps disappear within a few minutes.
4. **Record:** The product name, LOT number, total units and treatment areas are recorded in your file.

Some treatment areas and purposes may not be included in the approved instructions for use of the product in Türkiye (**off-label use**); for example, treatment of the masseter (jaw muscle) and teeth grinding, the neck and sweaty palms is not among the approved uses of many products. Although such use is widespread and accepted in the medical literature, your doctor will explain separately whether your planned area falls into this category, and this will be recorded in the relevant field of this form.

ANAESTHESIA	APPROXIMATE DURATION	HOSPITAL STAY / DISCHARGE
Usually not needed; ice or anaesthetic cream on request	About 10–20 minutes	Same day; 15–30 minutes of observation afterwards

3 Expected benefits and likelihood of success

- Softening of expression lines on the forehead, between the eyebrows and around the eyes, for a more rested appearance
- With masseter treatment, fewer teeth-grinding symptoms and a slimmer jawline
- With sweating treatment, a marked reduction in sweating
- A short procedure without surgical incisions, after which you can return to daily life straight away

The effect usually begins within **3–14 days**, reaches its peak at around 2 weeks and lasts on average **3–4 months** in the expression areas (it may last longer for sweating and masseter treatment). The degree and duration of the effect vary between individuals. Very deep, established lines may not disappear completely. If needed, a check-up is arranged at around 2 weeks, and where your doctor considers it appropriate a small additional treatment (touch-up) may be given.

4 Other treatment options

- **No treatment:** As this is a cosmetic procedure, you always have the option not to have it.
- **Dermal fillers:** May be more suitable for lines caused by volume loss rather than by movement.
- **Skin care and skin rejuvenation:** Retinoid creams, chemical peels, laser or mesotherapy can improve skin quality but do not reduce the movement of the facial muscles.
- **Surgery:** Operations such as a brow lift or face lift may offer a longer-lasting solution where there is sagging.
- **For medical uses:** A night guard for teeth grinding; antiperspirants and medicines for sweating.

5 What happens if the procedure is not performed?

If the treatment is not carried out, your current appearance or symptoms will follow their natural course. Expression lines may gradually become more noticeable with age; this poses no danger to your health.

You have the right to decline the recommended procedure, to postpone it, or to seek a second medical opinion. This decision will not affect any other healthcare offered to you in any way. You may withdraw your consent at any time before the procedure begins; please be aware, however, that once a procedure has started there may be stages at which stopping would be medically unsafe.

6 Preparing for the procedure

- Treatment is **not given, or is postponed,** in the following situations: pregnancy, breastfeeding, nerve–muscle diseases such as **myasthenia gravis**, ALS or Lambert–Eaton syndrome, active infection in the treatment area, known allergy to the product or, for some products, cow's milk protein allergy. Please tell us if any of these apply to you.

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- **Aminoglycoside antibiotics** (e.g. gentamicin) and some muscle relaxants can increase the effect of botulinum toxin; please tell us if you are taking them.
- If you have had botulinum toxin before, tell us when, which product and what the result was.
- To reduce the risk of bruising, if possible and after discussing it with your doctor, pause aspirin and similar medicines for a few days before treatment.
- Tell your doctor about **all medicines** you take (including blood thinners, aspirin, painkillers, weight-loss and hormone medicines) and any **herbal products and supplements** (such as omega-3, vitamin E, ginkgo, garlic, ginseng, fish oil). Do not stop any medicine on your own without your doctor's advice.
- Be sure to tell us about any **allergies**, bleeding or clotting problems, heart, lung, diabetes, blood pressure or thyroid conditions, previous operations and any problems you have had with anaesthesia.
- If there is any chance you may be pregnant, or if you are breastfeeding, tell us before the procedure.
- Smoking and nicotine products significantly impair wound healing. If possible, stop at least 2–4 weeks before the procedure and do not smoke during recovery.

7 Recovery: what to expect

First 4 hours	Do not lie down, and do not massage or press the treated area. This helps the product stay where it was placed. Slight redness and small bumps may be seen at the injection points.
First day	Avoid strenuous exercise, saunas, Turkish baths, sunbeds and very hot environments. Make-up can be applied after a few hours. A mild headache may occur; it passes with simple painkillers.
Days 3–14	The effect starts gradually. **If** small bruises occur at the injection points, they fade within a week. Do not have facials, skin treatments or face massage during this period.
Week 2	The effect reaches its peak. A check-up is arranged if needed; if there is asymmetry or an insufficient effect, a small additional treatment may be planned after the doctor's assessment.
Months 3–4 and later	The effect gradually wears off. A gap of at least 3 months between treatments is generally recommended.

8 Possible risks and complications

As with any medical procedure, this procedure carries some risks. Below, **expected temporary effects** and **complications** are listed separately and grouped by how often they occur. The figures given are **approximate** values based on the medical literature; your personal risk may be lower or higher depending on your age, general health, smoking and previous operations.

The great majority of complications are **temporary** and improve with appropriate treatment. Very rare but serious events are also included; being on this list does not mean they will happen to you, but you need to know about them to make an informed decision.

Expected, temporary effects (not complications — a normal part of healing)

- Mild pain, redness and small bumps at the injection points (settle within minutes to hours)
- Small bruises; **if** bruising occurs it fades within a few days to a week
- A slight feeling of heaviness or tightness in the forehead (first 1–2 weeks)

Common conditions (most are temporary or resolve with treatment)

- **Headache** — Particularly after a first treatment, about **1–10 in 100** patients have a mild headache in the first few days; it usually settles within a few days.

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- **Slight asymmetry or insufficient effect** — Because muscle strength differs between people, small differences between the two sides may remain or the effect may be less than expected. This is assessed at the 2-week check-up.
- **Over-raised outer eyebrow ("Spock brow")** — After forehead treatment the outer end of the eyebrow may lift too much; this is usually corrected with a small additional injection.

Uncommon conditions

- **Drooping of the upper eyelid (ptosis)** — After treatment between the eyebrows or on the forehead, about **1–5 in 100** patients may develop slight drooping of an upper eyelid. It is **temporary** and usually resolves within 2–6 weeks. During this time, eye drops that temporarily lift the eyelid and improve its appearance may be given.
- **Drooping of the eyebrow and heaviness of the forehead** — Caused by too much relaxation of the forehead muscle; improves as the effect wears off (weeks to a few months).
- **Uneven smile, weakness of lip movement, dribbling** — May occur with lower-face and masseter treatment if the product affects neighbouring muscles; temporary, but may last several weeks to months.
- **Dry eye, watering or double vision** — Uncommon with treatment around the eyes; temporary. Tell your doctor if you develop double vision.
- **Difficulty swallowing, neck weakness** — May occur with neck treatment; usually mild and temporary.
- **Reduced chewing strength, hollow-looking cheeks** — With masseter treatment, chewing hard foods may feel tiring for a while; very rarely the cheek may look slightly hollow or the smile uneven.
- **Hand weakness after treatment of the palms** — After injections into the palms for sweating, grip strength in the fingers may be temporarily reduced, and the injections themselves can be quite painful. The weakness usually resolves within a few weeks.

Rare or very rare, but potentially serious conditions

- **Spread of the effect to distant areas** — Very rarely, especially at high doses, the effect of the product may spread beyond the treated area, causing general muscle weakness, blurred vision, or **difficulty speaking, swallowing or breathing**. This requires **emergency treatment**; hospital admission and breathing support may be needed. At the doses used for cosmetic treatment this is extremely rare.
- **Serious allergic reaction** — A severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis) with hives, swelling of the face and lips or shortness of breath is extremely rare; it requires emergency treatment.
- **Loss of effect (antibody formation)** — Very rarely the body forms antibodies to the product and later treatments may not work. Frequent, high-dose treatment increases this risk.

General risks that apply to any surgical / medical procedure

- **Feeling faint (vasovagal reaction):** Dizziness, sweating and brief fainting may occur during an injection or blood draw; it passes quickly if you lie down.
- **Infection:** With skin disinfection and sterile materials the risk is very low; if it occurs it is usually treated with antibiotics.
- **Allergic reaction:** To the product, local anaesthetic or antiseptic used — ranging from mild redness to, very rarely, a severe allergic reaction (anaphylaxis). Our clinic is equipped with emergency equipment and medicines.
- **Cold sore (herpes) reactivation:** If you have had cold sores before, they may reappear in the treated area; please let us know.
- **Result not meeting expectations:** The degree and duration of the effect vary between individuals; additional sessions or touch-up treatment may be needed.

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This list does not include every possible complication; other unforeseeable and very rare events may occur. If a complication develops, your doctor will plan the necessary treatment and follow-up; this may require additional treatment, medication, procedures or a further operation.

9 When to contact us immediately

- **Difficulty swallowing, speaking or breathing**, or marked muscle weakness
- **Blurred or double vision**, or being unable to open an eyelid at all
- Rapidly developing swelling of the face, lips or tongue, hives or shortness of breath (allergic reaction)
- Increasing pain, redness, warmth or pus at the treatment site

If any of these occur, call your doctor without delay: +90 288 502 50 20 · WhatsApp +90 555 333 21 20. If you cannot reach us, go to the nearest emergency department or call 112 (the emergency number in Türkiye and across Europe).

10 Medication and everyday-life advice

- Do not lie down or massage the area for the first 4 hours; avoid strenuous exercise, saunas and Turkish baths on the first day.
- While the effect lasts, if you are going to have botulinum toxin, face massage or skin treatments from another doctor, tell them about this treatment.
- If you are planning a pregnancy during your course of treatment, discuss this with your doctor.
- Take the medicines prescribed for you (antibiotics, painkillers, etc.) at the recommended dose and for the recommended time. Do not take aspirin or similar medicines that may increase bleeding without asking your doctor.
- On flights or journeys longer than 4 hours after surgery, drink plenty of water, move around regularly and wear compression stockings if advised; this reduces the risk of leg clots.
- During recovery you are advised not to drink alcohol and to avoid smoking and nicotine products.
- Please attend all follow-up appointments. If you have travelled from abroad, follow-up after your return can continue by online consultation and photos/videos; if you need to see a local doctor, you will be given a written operation report and our recommendations.

11 Photographs, image records and your personal data

Photographs/videos may be taken before and after the procedure for planning, follow-up and assessment of the result. These records form part of your medical file and are kept confidential. Your images will **never be used for advertising, promotion or social media.**

Your images may be used for any other purpose **only with your separate and explicit permission**. Declining will not affect your treatment in any way, and you may withdraw your permission at any time:

☐ I agree that my images are used **only for medical records and treatment follow-up**.

☐ I permit my images to be used for scientific publication and medical education **in a way that does not identify me** (face/eye area covered).

☐ I permit my images to be used for scientific publication and medical education **in a way that may identify me**.

☐ I **do not permit** scientific/educational use.

Your personal and health data are processed under the Turkish Personal Data Protection Law No. 6698 (KVKK) and the relevant health legislation, for the purposes of diagnosis, treatment and legal obligations, by persons bound by professional confidentiality. You may consult our Data Protection Information Notice for details.

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12 Information and notes specific to you (completed by the doctor)

Patient-specific additional risks (co-existing diseases, medicines, previous operations), details of the plan, the patient's expectations, questions asked and answers given. If there is nothing to add, write "none".

13 Patient declaration

- ☐ I have read and understood this form in my own language. I was given enough time to think; I had the opportunity to ask questions and received satisfactory answers.
- ☐ My condition, the aim of the recommended procedure, how it will be done, by whom and where, its approximate duration, expected benefits, likelihood of success, alternatives and what may happen if it is not done have been explained to me verbally and in writing.
- ☐ The common and potentially serious risks, and the possible consequences of these complications (including that further treatment or a repeat procedure/operation may be needed), have been explained to me. I understand that the outcome of any medical procedure **cannot be 100% guaranteed**.
- ☐ I have given accurate and complete information about my health, the medicines I take, my allergies and past illnesses. I understand that incomplete or incorrect information may increase the risks.
- ☐ I understand that following the instructions given before and after the procedure plays a part in the result, and that attending follow-up appointments is important.
- ☐ I know that I can withdraw my consent at any time before the procedure begins. I understand that signing this form does not remove the doctor's duty of care.
- ☐ I am making this decision of my own free will, without pressure from anyone.
- ☐ I was asked about conditions that would prevent treatment (pregnancy, breastfeeding, nerve–muscle diseases, medicines) and I gave accurate information.
- ☐ I understand that the effect of botulinum toxin is temporary and that treatment must be repeated at regular intervals to maintain it. It has been explained to me that some treatment areas may be outside the product's approved instructions for use.
- ☐ I understand that this procedure is **cosmetic**, that it is not medically necessary and that I always have the option not to have it. I have discussed my expectations with my doctor, and the realistic result that can be achieved has been explained to me.
- ☐ I understand that perfect symmetry or an exact copy of the appearance in a photograph cannot be guaranteed, that the final result depends on how my tissues heal, and that in some cases a correction procedure may be needed.

- ☐ **I GIVE MY CONSENT to the procedure described above.**
- ☐ **I DO NOT ACCEPT the procedure described above. The possible consequences of refusing have been explained to me.**

We recommend the patient writes in their own handwriting: "I have read and understood this form and I give my consent."

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14 Signatures

	FULL NAME	SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
Patient			
Legal representative (parent / guardian) — relationship:			
Doctor providing information and performing the procedure			
Interpreter (if needed) — language:			
Witness (if needed)			

Interpreter's statement: I have translated this form and the doctor's verbal explanations to the patient / legal representative completely and accurately, in a language they understand.

FOR PATIENTS UNDER 18 OR WITH LIMITED DECISION-MAKING CAPACITY

For patients under 18, consent is given by a **parent or legal guardian**. The child is informed in a way appropriate to their age and maturity and their view is sought. For patients lacking capacity, consent is given by the legal representative.

☐ If we share parental responsibility, I declare that the other parent is aware of and agrees to this procedure.

☐ I declare that there is no court order or dispute concerning custody / guardianship (if there is, the relevant document has been shown to the doctor).

The child was informed in an age-appropriate way; the child's view: _____

This form has been prepared in two copies: one is kept in the patient's file and one is given to the patient / legal representative.

WITHDRAWAL OF CONSENT (COMPLETE ONLY IF YOU CHANGE YOUR MIND)

I withdraw the consent I gave above. The possible consequences of withdrawing have been explained to me.

Name, signature, date and time of patient/representative withdrawing consent: _____

This form has been prepared in accordance with the Turkish Patient Rights Regulation and the informed consent principles of the Turkish Medical Association. It complements, but does not replace, the verbal explanation given by your doctor.